

Φιλόξενος ὁ Λευκαδεύς

Philoxenus of Leucas and the Banquet Fragments

eul_aid: dsy

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι* [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: *Ποίησις* [Poetry](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Philoxenus of Leucas was a Greek dithyrambic poet from the island of Leucas, active in the late 5th and early 4th centuries BCE. He is famously associated with the court of Dionysius I, tyrant of Syracuse. A well-known anecdote claims he was sent to the quarries for criticizing the tyrant's poetry and, upon being recalled to hear a revised version, requested to be taken back. He was also said to have rivaled the poet Melanippides.

His most significant work is the lost dithyramb "Cyclops" or "Galatea", known only from fragments and descriptions. Other attributed titles, such as "Mysians" and "Deipnon," are also lost. Philoxenus was a major figure in the "New Music" movement, which emphasized musical complexity and innovative themes. His "Cyclops" was particularly influential for its humorous, romantic portrayal of the Cyclops Polyphemus, a treatment that later impacted Hellenistic poetry. Ancient critics often cited him as a leading, if controversial, example of this new stylistic direction.

Works (1)

- *Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δείπνου Τρυφεροῦ* · [Fragments of a Luxurious Banquet](#) · 65 passages